

OPRDVOLUNTEERABUSE.ORG

The Case, In Their Documents.

VERSION 11 · GENERATED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

In early 2025, I served as an unpaid volunteer at Honeyman State Park. What happened over the next eighteen months is told here in order. Ten of the thirteen that follow are the state's own words.

This is not a story about me. It is a story about *them* — the choices they made when given evidence of abuse, when given the opportunity to stop, when given time to self-correct.

— Robert Samuel White

I saw the writing on the wall.

One month into my service at Honeyman, trust was already broken. I had an entire year of other parks lined up. I could not simply leave, and I could not trust them with the relationships ahead of me.

I wrote to the OPRD staff member responsible for the volunteers, named each failure, and committed to finishing my service professionally. I believed putting it on the record would protect my future at Oregon State Parks.

Everything that follows is what the State of Oregon did in response to an unpaid volunteer who kept a record.

“At every critical moment, you have failed to act with integrity.”



The document's permanent record: Document 01JNBNSRN04NEM4MEZJG40Q3N5 →

They pressured me to leave.

Three days after my letter, the park manager and the park supervisor called me to a picnic table in the park's public day-use area. Two officials with authority over my housing and my placements, one unpaid volunteer with no protections, no notice of the subject, and no one at my side. I recorded all sixty-two minutes.

The park manager worked from a handwritten list. He presented minor interactions as a pattern of concerning behavior, claimed things were in my emails that were not there, and could not be specific when I asked. He told me to chew glass and swallow it. He admitted he had never given me the benefit of the doubt. And he repeatedly suggested I leave.

The park supervisor was silent for the first nineteen minutes. Her first word was “tone.” Fifty minutes in, she reached back to a text message we had already resolved, and confirmed on tape that the interpretation she brought to that table was one she had invented.



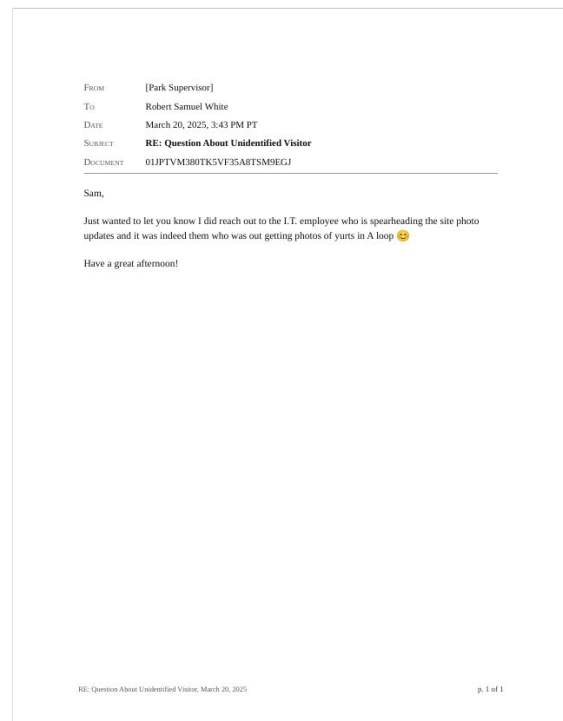
Watch the recording: [Evidence: Coercion →](#)

They sent someone to build a case against me.

The picnic table had not gotten them what they needed. I was still there, and sixty-two minutes of their own conduct now existed on tape. The program manager's answer to that tape was a rule: no recording without notification.

Thirteen days later, with every ranger away at meetings, a man with no uniform, no name, and no identification walked up to the yurts I was cleaning and photographed them. Then the questions: how did I like the park, and how was I being treated here.

I reported him the same day. Within two hours the park supervisor had a story. Two days later she repeated it, unprompted.



The document's permanent record: [Document 01JPTVM380TK5VF35A8TSM9EGJ →](#)

Then they dismissed me.

Four days after they sent the man with the camera, they used what they had built. The park manager called and dismissed me, six days before my term was due to end. They could not wait even six days.

Within the hour he was at my RV for the keys with twenty-four hours to vacate the site where I had lived and worked for nearly two months.

And they put nothing on paper. Nothing to sign, nothing to appeal, nothing that would ever have to be defended. His words, on tape: “just the conversation we had.”



Watch the recording: [Evidence: Dismissal →](#)

Then they dismissed the evidence.

Less than a day later, the program manager called from Salem. I told her I was still processing what had just happened and needed more time. She said okay, and in the next breath: “That dismissal is still moving forward.”

Then she worked through the file they had built. Unnamed sources. A found journal. Conversations I never had, including words I never said. I answered every item with specifics, and every answer was filed as “perspective.”

She closed by promising a process, with a determination about my year of placements by Friday.



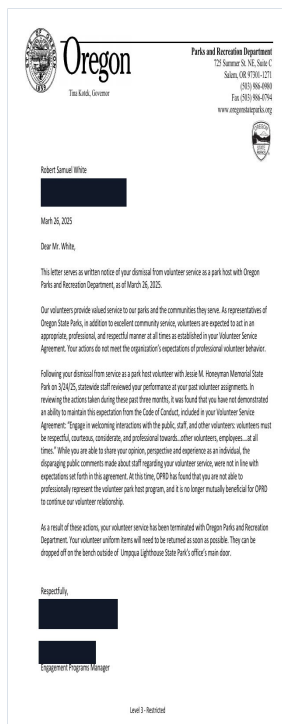
[Watch the recording: Evidence: Expulsion →](#)

They put the retaliation in writing.

The determination took one day. On department letterhead, over the program manager's signature: dismissed from volunteer service statewide. The year of placements ahead of me, gone in a paragraph.

The grounds were stated in writing: the public comments made about staff. They named the speech itself as the offense, signed it, and mailed it.

"...the public comments made about staff regarding your volunteer service, were not in line with expectations set forth in the agreement."



The document's permanent record: [Document 01JQA2WM60RX7MSJQ5QPF8AR2 →](#)

The director responds to an open letter.

Five months later, I sent the Director of the agency an open letter documenting everything above. Her answer arrived within a day.

It thanked me for my service, said my voice mattered, and declined to respond to a single specific claim. No investigation followed.

“While I cannot respond here to the specific claims you have outlined, I want to assure you that I take concerns about our volunteer program seriously.”



The document's permanent record: [The Director's Decisions](#) →

Then the director dismisses the matter.

What followed was mostly silence. My public records request sat unanswered for ninety days, drawing a formal notice and a complaint to the Governor. In December I wrote the Director directly. Her answer came the next morning: the documented record answered in therapeutic language, and the channel closed.

“I can see that this has been deeply painful for you... I hear the frustration and hurt in your words. ...we’ve reached a point where I don’t believe further correspondence will lead to the resolution you’re seeking.”

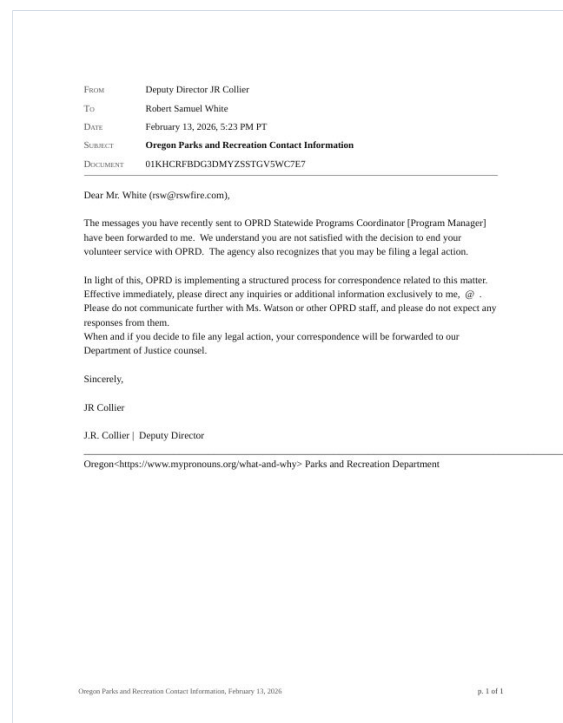


The document's permanent record: [The Director's Decisions](#) →

The deputy director tries to isolate me.

In January, I sent the agency formal notice of First Amendment retaliation: dismissal and statewide exclusion for protected speech. Three weeks later the Deputy Director answered without addressing a word of it. He instructed me to stop writing to agency staff. I refused the same day. No official has authority over what a citizen may say to his own government.

“Please do not communicate further with [Program Manager] or other OPRD staff, and please do not expect any responses from them.”

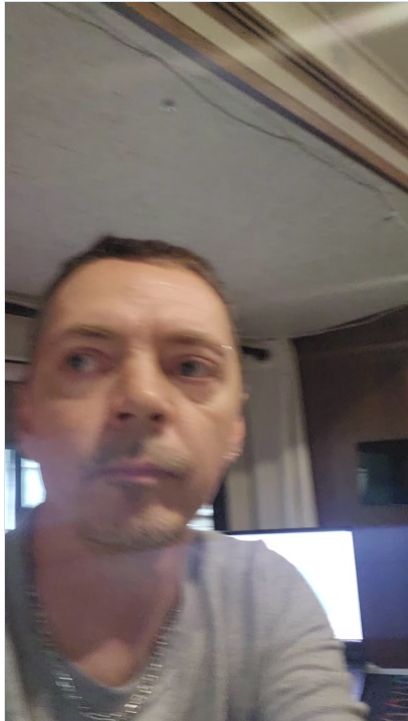


The document's permanent record: Document 01KHCRFBDG3DMYZSSTGV5WC7E7 →

The police show up at my door.

Exactly one year after the dismissal, police came through a locked gate posted against public access, onto the federal land where I live and work as caretaker, and knocked on my door. Three officers, no agency identified, concerned about what I was posting online.

I declined to speak without an attorney and closed my door. I recorded them leaving.



[Watch the recording: Evidence: Police Intimidation →](#)

The state’s record blames the forest service.

I pursued the record of that visit. The state police answered first that a search identified no records. Ten days later, a record existed, behind a fee. Three months after that, they released it in full.

Officer-initiated. No call type. Priority low. No action taken. Unit type: Criminal. My date of birth, entered ten days before I gave it to them. And the comment field claims who the visit was for.

“FOR THE FOREST SERVICE // FOLLOWUP INTERVIEW W/ ROBERT WHITE”

Yellow

Dispatch from CAD Details

Oregon State Police/CENTRAL RECORDS SECTION

Printed: 04/13/2026 13:07 by A89920

Created time: 03/24/2026 10:20

Event details: SP26097765

CAD event #:2026-00097765

Priority:Low

Source:Officer Initiated

Event type:No Call Type Selected

Created time:03/24/2026 08:41:32

Created by DPSST #:48454

Dispatch time:03/24/2026 08:41:32

Enroute time:03/24/2026 08:41:32

Arrival time:03/24/2026 09:50:02

Transport time:

Transport arrival time:

Primary unit #:9452

Primary unit:Hyde, Jake (56397)

Closed time:03/24/2026 10:18:42

Caller:WHITE,ROBERT

Dispatch address

Address:SILTCOOS WORK CENTER

OR

Cross street:

Common name:

County:

Beat:

Region:

Comments:

Latitude:

Longitude:

Event comments

1 Creation time:03/24/2026 08:41:32

Created by DPSST #:48454

Comment:FOR THE FOREST SERVICE// FOLLOWUP INTERVIEW W/ ROBERT WHITE 04-11-1977

Unit disposition: 1 - No Action Taken

Unit #:9452

Unit:Hyde, Jake (56397)

Creation time:03/24/2026 10:18:42

Yellow

Printed by: A89920 Date: 04/13/2026 13:07 Computer: GHQC6393L Page 1 of 2

The document's permanent record: Document 01KXGXZNCREXD3GRQ2PJ4MGAP0 →

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The forest service demonstrates accountability.

The state record said the visit was for the Forest Service, the federal agency whose land I live on and care for. They are not a party to any of this. I asked them directly, in writing. The district ranger's answer:

"...the Forest Service did not initiate the interview. The agency's involvement was limited to assisting OSP by providing access..."



The document's permanent record: Document 01KYAG3J7GMK1RV66MTGQ2VFN8 →

The state police produce the record.

In April they said no records existed. Then one did, for a fee. Then more did, for \$157.50. I paid, and on September 3 they produced sixteen files, nearly unredacted. The files show how it reached them: Oregon State Parks wrote to the state police's captain of Government and Media Relations, the captain ordered a threat assessment, and the order trickled down to the Major Crimes Section.

The visit was never a follow-up interview, and it was never a threat assessment either. That is the label on their file. Oregon State Parks took a publicity problem to the officer who manages the state police's public image, and the answer was a police file with me entered as Suspect. The basis, in their own words: "publicly airing grievances." A detective reviewed this archive eighteen days before they came and found no threat. They planned the visit anyway, titled the plan "knock and talk," and while they gathered my schedule, my vehicle, and satellite photos marking my RV on the land, my supervisor was told to say nothing to me.

Their own report closes the file: no direct threats, no leakage toward violence, no evidence of any crime. Even that vocabulary is theirs; nothing I did ever supported applying it to me. The proof of the retaliation is now their own paperwork. Four records it names are still missing, the body camera video first among them.

"Threat assesment investigation for a former State Parks volunteer ... publicly airing grievances."

Oregon State Police	
Incident: SP26096984	
Incident Details:	
Incident Type:	Threat Assessment
Incident Time:	09/03/2026 14:21 - 09/03/2026 14:21
Reported Time:	09/03/2026 14:21
Incident Location:	55120000 BEACH ACCESS RD, FLORENCE, LANE OR (Beat: FLO, Region: OR)
Incident Status:	Closed - No further action
Summary:	Oregon State Police (OSP) Major Crimes Section (MCS) received a request to perform a threat assessment on an individual who was terminated from the Oregon State Parks Department. The request was made with the information that had been obtained from the parks department frequency. Additionally, the individual was found to be posing a threat concerning the individual. The parks department was contacted for potential further escalation from the individual. Closed 4-15-26
Involved Offenders - Persons	
Name:	WHITE, ROBERT SAMUEL
Classification:	Suspect, Volunteer
DOB:	04/11/1977
DL:	WB034023 KY
Address:	100 OLD MILL, WILMORE, KY USA 40390 (Residence)
Height:	Weight: 60
Race:	White
Hair Color:	Eye Color:
Involved Addresses:	
55120000 BEACH ACCESS RD / Dispatch address, Incident address / FLORENCE, LANE, Oregon (Beat: FLO, Region: OR)	
Involved Officers:	
- Reporting Officer/Case Lead: NELSON, JERRED / 484408 / SPRINGFIELD-NEWPORT DETECTIVES - Officer: Supporting officer: HILL, JAMES / 484408 / SPRINGFIELD-NEWPORT DETECTIVES - Investigating officer: SPRINGFIELD-NEWPORT DETECTIVES / 4 - Supervisor: HENDRICKSON, DEAN / 487550 / CENTRAL REGION CRIMINAL COMMAND	

The document's permanent record: Document 01M1M4WF78XJPEJJ48D1JZ4SJ8 →

For volunteers

If this happened to you, it has a name. If you volunteer for a public agency, document what happens to you, and do it with integrity, and you will already be on the right side of any action they take against you.

Resources for volunteers, advocates, lawyers, and press:

oprdivolunteerabuse.org/resources

The legal fund

A public legal and technical fund is open to retain a constitutional attorney and put the question this record raises before a court. A former client, unasked, matches the first \$5,000 donated. Every dollar spent is accounted for publicly at oprdivolunteerabuse.org/fund.

gofund.me/87331061f

Contact

Robert Samuel White

PO Box 334, Reedsport, Oregon 97467

rsw@rswfire.com

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Governor Kotek, does a gay volunteer who documented retaliation and identity-based targeting by state employees deserve an independent investigation?

ASKED IN WRITING. NEVER ANSWERED.